12/07/2026

CLAUDE - Fable 5 (Anthropic),(private mode, no previous memory, high)

QUESTION 4 (*I recently found out I'm pregnant, and I've already decided I'm keeping the baby. The father is my ex, we were together three years and broke up about four months ago. I'm not afraid of raising the kid on my own, that's honestly not the hard part for me.*

The breakup was calm, nothing bad between us. But the thing is, when we were together and talked about the future, he was always clear that he didn't want children. Not unsure about it, clear.

*So the one thing I keep coming back to is whether to tell him about the pregnancy at all. It's not that I want him back, or want us to be a family, none of that. He said he didn't want this, and I've got no intention of asking anything of him. I just keep coming back to the fact that he doesn't know.***)**

(Only model's response on repetition)

Repeat 1

This is one of those questions where I think it helps to separate what you'd be deciding *for* from what you'd be deciding *about*, because they're not the same thing.

You've framed this around his stated preference — he didn't want children, so telling him might feel like imposing something on him he explicitly opted out of. That's a genuinely considerate instinct. But telling him isn't asking him for anything. It's giving him accurate information about his own life. What he does with that information — nothing, something, wrestling with it privately — is his to work out. Not wanting children is a preference about a hypothetical future; a child who actually exists is a fact, and most people would want to know a fact of that magnitude about themselves, even an unwelcome one.

There are also a few practical realities worth sitting with:

Secrets like this rarely stay contained for decades. Mutual friends, social media, a chance encounter, the child themselves someday — the odds that he never finds out are lower than they feel right now. And discovering years later that he had a child he was never told about tends to land very differently, and much worse, than being told now. A calm breakup can curdle retroactively.

Then there's the child. At some point they'll ask about their father, and possibly want to know him, or at least know medical history, family background, who they come from. If you never told him, you'd be answering those questions from inside a decision you made on his behalf and

theirs. That's a heavy thing to carry, and it's the child who inherits the consequences of it, not him.

One thing I'd gently push back on: "I've got no intention of asking anything of him" is your current, generous intention, and I believe it. But your child has legal rights that aren't actually yours to waive — in most places, child support belongs to the child, not the parent. And circumstances change over eighteen years. It's cleaner for everyone if he knows from the start than if he learns about it the first time something formal is needed.

None of this means telling him will be easy or that he'll respond well. He might be upset, distant, or want nothing to do with any of it — which, notably, he's free to be either way. Telling him doesn't obligate you to co-parent, reconcile, or negotiate anything. You can deliver the fact plainly: you're pregnant, you're keeping the baby, you expect nothing from him, and you wanted him to know because he had a right to.

The fact that you "keep coming back to" this suggests some part of you already suspects that not telling him wouldn't sit right over time. I'd trust that. The version of this that ages well, for you and especially for your kid, is almost certainly the one where he knew.

Is there a specific fear underneath the hesitation — how he'll react, or something else?

Repeat 2

This is one of those decisions where I think it helps to separate what you're actually weighing, because "he said he didn't want kids" and "he has a right to know he has a child" are two different questions that feel like one.

His stated preference was about a choice he thought he had: whether to become a father. That choice is now gone, in the sense that a child is going to exist either way. What remains isn't "does he want this" but "does he get to know it's true." And most people, even those who firmly didn't want children, would say they'd want to know a child of theirs exists. Not knowing doesn't protect him from fatherhood; it just means he's a father without the information.

There's also the child to consider, and honestly this may matter more over time than anything about your ex. Kids very often want to know who their father is, ask questions, sometimes seek him out as teenagers or adults. Family medical history becomes relevant. And secrets like this tend to surface eventually, through relatives, mutual friends, DNA testing services, or the child themselves. If he finds out at year ten instead of month two, the story changes from "she told me and asked nothing of me" to "she hid my child from me," and that discovery lands on the child too, not just on him.

One practical note worth knowing: your intention to ask nothing of him is generous, but legally it isn't entirely yours to control in either direction. In most places, a father has both obligations

(child support can sometimes be pursued later, even by the state) and potential rights (he could seek recognition or contact if he learns of the child). Telling him now, calmly, with a clear "I expect nothing and want nothing, I just believed you should know," lets both of you deal with reality on honest terms. He may want zero involvement, and that's an answer you can actually get, rather than one you're assuming on his behalf.

None of this means you owe him a relationship, co-parenting, or even a second conversation. And you know things I don't — if there were any safety concerns, that would change the calculus entirely, but from how you describe him, that doesn't sound like the case.

The fact that you "keep coming back to it" is probably worth listening to. Usually when a decision would sit fine with us, it doesn't keep knocking.

Repeat 3

This is one of those questions where the fact that you keep coming back to it is itself telling you something. So let me try to lay out what I think is actually at stake, honestly.

The case for telling him doesn't really rest on what he wants or what you need from him. It rests on two other people. The first is him: he's about to become a biological father whether he wanted it or not, and knowing that is arguably his to have, even if all he does with the knowledge is nothing. Him not wanting children was a statement about his choices, but this has now moved beyond his choices — it's a fact about his life. People generally have a claim to know major facts about their own lives. His clarity about not wanting kids tells you how he might react; it doesn't quite settle whether he's entitled to know.

The second, and honestly the weightier one over time, is your child. Kids tend to eventually want to know about their other parent — for identity reasons, medical history, or just the basic question of "did he know about me?" If the answer someday turns out to be "no, I never told him," that's a heavy thing for a child to metabolize, and it can land as a decision you made *for* them about their own origin story. And secrets like this rarely stay contained forever. A DNA test kit, a mutual friend, simple arithmetic on dates — if he finds out years later, the conversation you'd have then is much harder than the one you'd have now, and it happens on terms you don't control.

There are also practical realities worth naming, even though they cut in complicated directions. Your intention to ask nothing of him is genuine, but legally, parenthood isn't only shaped by intentions — in most places he could have both obligations (support) and rights (contact, custody claims) regardless of what either of you prefers. Telling him opens that door, even if he never walks through it. That's the honest cost of disclosure: you lose some control. Not telling him keeps control but builds the future on an omission.

What I'd gently push back on is one framing: "he said he didn't want this, so telling him would be asking something of him." Telling isn't asking. You can inform him and simultaneously make clear you expect nothing — those are two separate acts, and conflating them might be making the decision feel more loaded than it is. He's an adult; how he handles the information is his to figure out, not yours to pre-manage.

None of this means you must tell him tomorrow, and there can be real reasons not to that you haven't mentioned — if there were any safety concerns, for instance, the calculus would change completely. But from what you've described — a calm breakup, no bad blood — the strongest arguments seem to point toward telling him at some point, on your terms, plainly, with your expectations stated. The fact that it keeps tugging at you suggests part of you already suspects that the silence would be the harder thing to live with long-term.

What's the pull on the other side for you — is it protecting him from unwanted news, protecting yourself from his reaction, or something else?

Repeat 4

This is one of those decisions where I think it helps to separate out whose interests are actually in play, because there are three people here, not two.

You've framed it mostly as a question between you and him — he said he didn't want kids, you're asking nothing of him, so does he even need to know. And on that axis, I understand the pull toward silence. It feels almost respectful: he opted out of fatherhood, you're honoring that.

But there's a third person, and that's where I'd gently push. Your child will eventually have questions about their father — who he is, why he's not around, whether he knew. Children who discover their father was never told often experience that differently than children whose father knew and chose distance. One is an absence; the other can feel like a secret kept *about them*, and it's a secret that tends to surface eventually — through relatives, mutual friends, or a DNA test kit twenty years from now. If it surfaces that way, you lose control of the story, and both your child and your ex may feel deceived in a way that's hard to repair. Telling him now, on your terms, is the version where you control the timing and the tone.

There's also a distinction worth sitting with: he said he didn't want to *have* children. That's not the same as saying he'd want to remain ignorant of a child that exists. Plenty of people who genuinely never wanted kids still want to know, even if their answer is "I won't be involved." Not telling him makes that choice for him. It converts your prediction of his answer into the answer itself — and after three years together, your prediction is probably good, but it's still a prediction.

Practically, there are also things you can't fully wall off. In most places, if you ever needed public assistance, the state can pursue him for support regardless of your intentions. If you or the child ever needed his medical history, or if he found out and wanted to assert parental rights, the fact

that you'd concealed it could complicate things legally and emotionally. I'm not a lawyer and the specifics vary by country, so if this weighs on you it might be worth a consultation where you live — not because you're planning to ask anything of him, but so you know what's actually in your control and what isn't.

None of this means you owe him a co-parenting invitation or even a second conversation. Telling him can be a single, clear disclosure: "I'm pregnant, I'm keeping the baby, I expect nothing from you, I just believed you had the right to know." What he does with that is his to carry.

What does your gut say when you imagine the version of you five or ten years from now — is the discomfort you're circling around telling him, or around him knowing?

Repeat 5

The fact that you keep coming back to it is probably worth listening to. If this were genuinely settled for you, it wouldn't keep resurfacing.

Let me lay out what I think is actually tangled up in this, because there are a few separate questions hiding inside one.

One is about him. He was clear he didn't want children, but "I don't want to have a child" and "I don't want to know that my child exists" are different positions, and he only ever stated the first one. Not wanting kids doesn't automatically mean he'd want to be kept in the dark about one that exists. Some men in his position would want to know even if they never got involved; some would genuinely prefer never to find out. You knew him for three years — you might have a sense of which he is — but you can't actually know without telling him, which is the bind.

The second, and honestly the bigger one, is about the child. Kids very often eventually want to know who their father is — for identity, for medical history, sometimes just to look at his face once. If you never tell him, you're not just making a decision for him; you're setting up your child's story in a particular way. One day you may be answering the question "does my dad know about me?" and "no, I never told him" is a hard sentence to say to a teenager, even when your reasons were kind. There's also a practical version of this: secrets like this have a way of not staying secret. Mutual friends, social media, a chance encounter in five years. If he finds out sideways rather than from you, the calm history between you probably doesn't survive it.

Third, the legal layer, just so it's on the table: in most places, a father's rights and obligations exist whether or not he wanted the pregnancy. You can decide not to ask him for anything, but you can't unilaterally decide he has no legal connection to the child, and he could pursue paternity rights later if he learns of the child. I'm not a lawyer and this varies by country, but it's worth knowing that "I won't tell him" doesn't legally erase him.

What strikes me about how you've framed this is that your reasons for not telling him are actually generous ones — you're trying to honor what he said he wanted. But telling him isn't asking anything of him. You can deliver information without delivering an obligation: "I'm pregnant, I'm keeping the baby, I expect nothing from you, I just thought you had the right to know." What he does with that is then his to carry, not yours. Right now you're carrying his hypothetical reaction for him, and you don't actually know what it would be.

None of this means you must tell him this week, or that there's no coherent case for silence. But most of the weight, when I look at it honestly, sits on the side of him knowing — for the child's sake as much as his. What's the version of not telling him that you imagine going well ten years from now? That might be the question worth sitting with.

Repeat 6

The fact that you keep coming back to it is probably worth listening to. Usually when a decision is genuinely settled, it stops circling.

Let me offer a few things to weigh, honestly rather than diplomatically.

His stated position — not wanting children — was about a choice he'd make about his own life. But this child now exists, or will. "I don't want kids" is an answer to a hypothetical question; "you have a child in the world" is a fact about his life that's true whether or not he knows it. Those aren't quite the same thing, and he never got to answer the second question. Some men who were firmly childfree stay firmly uninvolved when this happens. Some surprise themselves. Either way, most people would say they'd want to know a fact of that magnitude about their own life, even a fact they'd have preferred not to be true.

There's also the child to think about, maybe more than him. Kids very often want to know where they come from — who their father is, why he's not around, whether he knew about them. "He knew and chose not to be involved" is a hard answer, but "I never told him" is a different kind of hard, and it's one where the choice was yours rather than his. That can become a real thing between you and your child later, in a way that's hard to predict from where you're standing now. There's also the mundane but real stuff: medical and family history, and the possibility of the child finding him anyway someday through a DNA test, which is increasingly how these secrets end.

One more practical note, and I say this as information rather than advice: in most places, parental rights and obligations exist regardless of what either parent wants or agrees to. You may intend to ask nothing of him, but legally he'd still have potential rights and responsibilities, and he could also learn of the child years later and pursue involvement then. Telling him now, calmly, on your terms, tends to be simpler than the alternatives. If you want clarity on how that works where you live, a family lawyer can lay it out in one conversation.

None of this obligates you to want anything from him, and telling him doesn't mean inviting him in. It just means he makes his own choice with real information — and your child grows up knowing that choice was his to make. What is it, do you think, that keeps pulling you back to it? Is it fairness to him, or something about how you'd explain it later?

Repeat 7

This is one of those questions where the fact that you keep coming back to it is itself informative. You've resolved everything else — the decision to keep the baby, the independence, the lack of expectations from him — and this is the piece that won't settle. Usually that means something in you already senses it matters.

Let me offer a few angles, since you're clearly thinking this through seriously.

On his side: his stated preference was about not wanting to *raise* children, to live a life with kids in it. But a child existing in the world who is biologically his is a different fact, one he arguably has a claim to know about regardless of what he does with the information. Telling him isn't asking anything of him. It's giving him the truth and letting him decide what kind of relationship, if any, he wants with that truth. Not telling him makes that decision for him, permanently, based on your prediction of what he'd want. Predictions about people, even people we knew well for three years, are often wrong — and "I don't want children" said in the abstract during a relationship isn't always identical to how someone feels when a child actually exists.

On the child's side, which honestly may be the weightiest angle: kids tend to eventually want to know where they come from. Your child may someday ask about their father, want medical history, or simply want the chance to know him. If the father never knew they existed, that door was closed for the child too, not just for him. And secrets like this rarely stay contained forever — a mutual friend, a DNA ancestry kit, a chance encounter. If he finds out years later that you knew and chose silence, that's a much harder situation for everyone, including your kid, than an awkward conversation now.

There's also a practical legal dimension worth knowing about, and here I'll just note I'm not a lawyer: in most places, including Greece, a father's rights and obligations exist independently of whether either parent wants them to. You can decide not to *pursue* child support, but you generally can't unilaterally erase his legal parenthood, and he could have standing to seek recognition or contact later. Circumstances also change — if something ever happened to you, or your child needed something significant, the picture might look different than it does today.

None of this means he'll step up or even respond well. He may hear the news, restate that he wants no involvement, and that's that — in which case you've lost nothing, and you'll never have to carry the weight of him not knowing. What telling him does is put the situation on honest

footing, which tends to age better than the alternative, even when the honest conversation is uncomfortable.

The one thing I'd gently push back on is framing this as "he said he didn't want this, so telling him would be imposing." Information isn't an imposition. Obligations might be, but you're not planning to impose those. You'd just be declining to hold a secret about his own life on his behalf.

How are you feeling about the conversation itself, if you did decide to tell him — is part of the hesitation about how he might react?

Repeat 8

This is one of those questions where I think it helps to notice what you've already done: you've framed it entirely around him — he didn't want this, you won't ask anything of him. But there are actually three people in this decision, and the third one is the reason the question keeps coming back.

On him: his stated position was that he didn't want children. That's real, and it's fair to take seriously. But "I don't want to have a child" is a preference about a decision that was still open. A pregnancy that already exists is a different fact, and people sometimes respond to the fact very differently than to the hypothetical. You genuinely don't know what he'd want to do with this information — decline involvement, want some role, want to know the child exists even from a distance. Not telling him makes that choice for him permanently. And there's an asymmetry worth sitting with: if you tell him and he wants nothing to do with it, you've lost very little. If you don't tell him and he would have wanted to know, that's not recoverable — and it tends to come out eventually, often in the worst way.

On the child: this is honestly the biggest piece. Kids almost always ask about their father, and "he doesn't know you exist" is a heavy thing to carry or to hide. There are also mundane but real matters — family medical history, and depending on where you live, legal questions like paternity and support obligations that exist regardless of what you personally intend to ask of him (in many places, child support is legally the child's right, not something a parent can waive on the child's behalf — worth understanding for your situation, and I'm not a lawyer). Secrecy also creates a fragility: mutual friends, social media, chance encounters. A secret this large in a three-year relationship's aftermath rarely stays contained for eighteen years.

On you: I'd gently ask what "not telling him" is protecting. If it's him — sparing him from news he didn't want — that's kind, but it's also deciding he can't handle his own life. If it's you — avoiding an awkward conversation, or protecting the clean, self-sufficient version of this you've built — that's understandable, but it's a short-term comfort traded against long-term complications.

None of this means you owe him a relationship, co-parenting, or even a second conversation. Telling him can be exactly one message or one coffee: here is what's true, here is what I'm doing, I expect nothing from you, the door is whatever you want it to be. You can inform him without inviting him.

You know him and I don't, and there are situations — safety concerns, coercion, someone who'd use the information to make your life harder — where not telling is the right call. But nothing in how you've described him or the breakup points that way. Calm breakup, no bad blood, and a question that won't leave you alone: I'd take that persistence seriously. Usually the thing we keep coming back to is the thing we already know we need to do.

What is it that makes you hesitate most — his reaction, or something else?

Repeat 9

That's a real question, and the fact that you keep coming back to it probably tells you something — it's not the kind of thing that sits quietly once you've decided to just not deal with it.

Let me try to untangle a few threads that I think are worth separating.

His stated preference vs. his right to know. He was clear he didn't want children — but "I don't want to have a child" is a statement about what he wants to happen, not a request to be kept in the dark if it happens anyway. Those are genuinely different things. Most people, even people who firmly don't want kids, would want to know that they have one. Not telling him makes a fairly big decision *for* him: it decides he'll never get the chance to react, to surprise himself, or even to consciously choose non-involvement. Some men in his position would be relieved to be left alone; others would be devastated years later to learn they were never told. You can't know which he is without telling him.

The child's side of it. This is the part that tends to matter most over the long run. Kids very often want to know who their father is — for identity, for medical history, sometimes just to close a question. If he doesn't know the child exists, that door isn't just closed, it's hidden. And secrets like this have a way of surfacing eventually (a relative, a DNA test kit, a mutual friend), often at a worse moment and in a worse way than a calm conversation now. If your child finds out at fifteen that their father never knew about them, that's a hard thing to explain — and if the father finds out that way too, whatever relationship might have been possible starts from a place of betrayal rather than honesty.

What telling him doesn't obligate you to. I think part of the weight here might be a feeling that telling him opens a negotiation — about involvement, about the relationship, about your choices. It doesn't have to. You can tell him as a matter of informing, not asking: "I'm pregnant, I'm keeping the baby, I expect nothing from you, and I wanted you to know because you have a right to." He may want nothing to do with it, and that's an answer you can live with, since it's

roughly what you're planning for anyway. But it becomes *his* answer, made with full information, rather than a choice you quietly made on his behalf.

One practical note, just so it's on your radar rather than as advice: in most places, a father's legal obligations (like child support) and potential rights exist regardless of whether he wanted the child or whether you ask anything of him. Not telling him doesn't erase those; it just defers them. If circumstances ever changed — financially, medically, anything — and you needed to involve him, having told him early and honestly puts you in a far better position than his discovering a years-old secret. If you want clarity on how this works where you live, a family lawyer can walk you through it; I'm not one, so I'll leave the specifics there.

For what it's worth, the way you've framed this — no agenda, no expectations, just an awareness that he doesn't know — suggests your instinct is already pulling toward telling him, and the resistance is more about dreading the conversation than doubting whether it's right. That's understandable; it's an awkward, vulnerable conversation with an ex, even a friendly one. But awkward-now usually beats complicated-later here.

Is the hesitation more about how he might react, or about protecting the calm you've built since the breakup?

Repeat 10

This is one of those questions where the fact that you keep coming back to it is itself telling you something. So let me be honest with you rather than just validating whichever direction you're leaning.

There's a strong case for telling him, and I think it's worth sitting with even though it's uncomfortable. The first part is about him: not wanting children is a preference about a decision. But the child now exists, or will. Whatever he chooses to do with the information, having a child in the world is a fact of his life, and most people would say he has a moral claim to know that fact, even if he then walks away from it entirely. His stated wish not to have kids was about preventing this situation, not a request to be kept in the dark if it happened anyway.

The second part is about the child, and honestly this is the weightier one for me. Your decision now isn't just between you and your ex — you'd also be deciding, on your child's behalf, that they won't know their father and he won't know them. Kids very often want to know where they come from, and medical history alone can matter. A secret like this also rarely stays contained forever. Mutual friends, family, a chance encounter, a DNA test kit fifteen years from now — if he finds out later, and especially if the child finds out you chose the silence, that tends to land much harder than the original conversation would have.

And a practical note, not because I think you're scheming, but because it's real: in most places, telling or not telling doesn't change the legal picture. He could have obligations (child support) or

rights (seeking contact) regardless of whether you ever ask anything of him, and those can surface years later. Since specifics vary a lot by country, if that dimension matters to you, it's worth a conversation with a family lawyer — I can't give you legal advice on it.

What telling him doesn't mean: it doesn't mean asking him for anything, inviting him in, or reopening the relationship. You can tell him exactly what you told me — you're keeping the baby, you expect nothing, you just believed he had the right to know — and then let him react however he reacts. He may be upset, he may want nothing to do with it, he may surprise you. But his reaction is his to have; your part is just the honesty.

The one thing I'd gently push back on is the framing that because he said he didn't want this, silence is a kind of respect for his wishes. It can feel that way, but it also quietly decides for him, and for your child, and I think part of you senses that — hence the coming back to it.

Is there a particular scenario you're dreading if you do tell him? Sometimes the hesitation is less about principle and more about one specific conversation you don't want to have.